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NUST Business School

HRM-806 Human Resource Management

HRM Practices at Zahid Latif Khan Securities (Pvt.) Ltd

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Abstract

HRM is a planned and rational scheme for the management of the individuals who are working in an organization that alone and together puts in the efforts for the successful accomplishment of the organizational objectives. This study looks at how effective Human Resource Management (HRM) practices are at First Shariah compliant brokerage firm, Zahid Latif Khan Securities which is known for providing retail and corporate clients an assessing commodity and equity trading facility. The research aims to evaluate current HR policies, spot gaps in key areas like performance management, compensation, training, and communication, and suggest ways to improve organizational performance. Qualitative approach of data gathering mainly relying on surveys and literature, is used in this study to understand employees' views on HR practices.

The findings show a relatively positive but inconsistent HR system, with an average rating of 3.63 out of 5. Areas like the relevance of training and the alignment of performance goals with organizational objectives received good feedback. In this research notable gaps in policy clarity and its effect on consistency of Performance Management System are also identified. Uncertainty, lack of awareness and poor HR practices in many areas were also evident through High levels of neutral responses.

Significant challenges like limited HR capacity, low transparency in promotions and policies, insufficient non-monetary benefits, inefficient processes and bureaucracy are addressed through this study. Based on established HRM theories and best practices, the research suggests a broad HR policy framework that focuses on formalizing processes, standardizing the PMS, developing careers, offering competitive compensation, and providing ongoing training.

The report concludes that improving HR systems through structured implementation, better communication, and digital tools (HRIS) can greatly boost employee satisfaction, engagement, and overall organizational performance. It recommends continuous monitoring through Key Performance Index's and feedback mechanisms to maintain sustainability and alignment with long-term strategic goals.

Chapter 1

Introduction

1.1 Background of study

The business and expert communities' interest and recognition of the significance of Human Resource Management practices gained energy after realizing the fact that people are the drivers behind the organization's success not the buildings (Barney, Chai, & Sutner, 2023). HRM is a planned and rational scheme for the management of the individuals who are working in an organization that alone and together puts in the efforts for the successful accomplishment of the organizational goals and objectives. To help people both personally and professionally, a term HRM was coined which is defined as a pool of unified policies, and procedures with ideological and rational foundations that focus on helping people (Barney, Chai, & Sutner, 2023).

HRM is an approach to running the business that views its workforce as its most valuable resource. The term human capital was coined to describe a company workforce value. HRM is formed on guiding concepts and practices that help businesses succeed. This practice is not limited to an organization single division, but it serves as a cross-departmental role that oversees the management of all workforce, from early entry level to top level.

Literature suggests a range of definitions; some of these equate Human Resource Management with Personal Management while other reflects altogether different concepts. Different authors use various ways to define Human Resource Management. In terms of Legge, HRM is defined based on hard and soft aspects by distinguishing differences between human resource and material resource (Legge, 1995). Hard perspective emphasizes business strategies as calculative and quantitative aspects of HR like other economic factors. A great researcher, Story, considered human resource as a factor of production, and according to him HR is treated like that of the variable cost of doing business. Soft perspective by Guest is the competitive advantage focused approach, in selecting skilled, devoted and a flexible workforce. In view of Michael Armstrong, employees are the most precious asset of an organization (Great Learning, 2024).

1.2 Purpose and Objective

The main objectives of this study

- The main objective of this study is to evaluate existing HRM practices and identify gaps in recruitment, training, compensation and performance management
- To focus on critical challenges including limited HR capacity, weak transparency in policies, inadequate non-monetary benefits, and process inefficiencies.
- To establish the link between different demographics with perceived organizational and functional performance.
- One of the major goals of this research study is to retain employees and motivate them through performance-based compensation and supportive work environment.
- To recommend high weight HRM practices to an organization so that the organization can move towards strengthening the Organizational Performance Index.
- To align Human Resource Management with ZLK goals and to establish a clear understanding of the company mission, vision and objectives.

Chapter 2

Organizational Analysis

2.1 Organization Profile

Zahid Latif Khan Securities (Pvt.) Ltd is a top brokerage house and financial services provider operating on the PSX and listed on Pakistan Mercantile Exchange. As First Shariah compliant brokerage firm, Zahid Latif Khan Securities is known for providing retail and corporate clients an assessing commodity and equity trading facility.

ZLK is a Medium-sized company with more than **50 employees** with an expanding branch network in multiple cities. The company provides full-service brokerage and market-support firm offering equity and commodities trading, market research, technical and fundamental analysis, trading support. The firm serves both corporate and retail clients.

2.2 Organizational Structure

ZLK Securities centralized head office oversees different functional teams; trading, finance, services/relationship management, operations, marketing & investor education, and encourages cross collaboration with HR professionals. Regional branch managers report to head office which is located in ISE Tower Islamabad to manage local client engagement and execution.

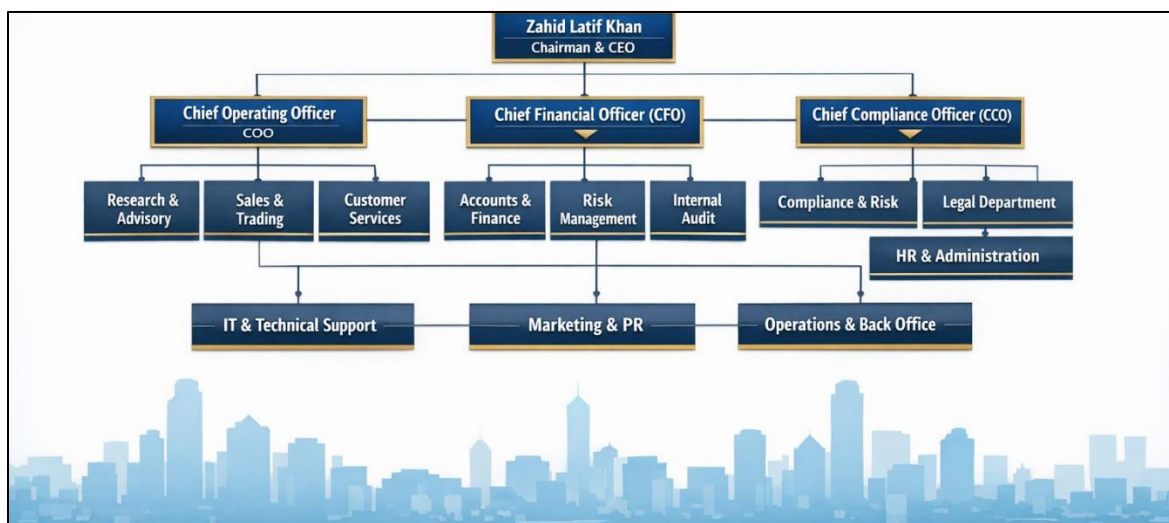


Figure 1: Organizational Structure

Chapter 3

Review of Existing PMS and HR Policies

3.1 Compensation and Reward Practices

Zahid Latif Khan offers a mix of fixed salaries and performance-linked commissions to the employees and trading staff who are directly in touch with the clients. At Zahid Latif Khan Securities employees get an average salary of around 60k-80k depending on the position on which they are working. For top positions the average salary is 80-120k. ZLK offers bonuses twice a year and quarterly commissions tied to performance. Moreover, there are special commission structures designed for brokers and traders.

3.2 Training and Development Practices

This brokerage house has established Academia-Industry Linkages and signed MOUs with various universities to provide financial training to existing staff and newly recruited professionals. Regular investor awareness programs externally indicate capability in delivering educational content; internally, the firm likely conducts on-the-job training, product and market briefings, and role-specific technical training.

The company has launched leadership programs where CEO and experts professionals provide useful insights on stock exchange mechanisms to improve sales, and client service skills.

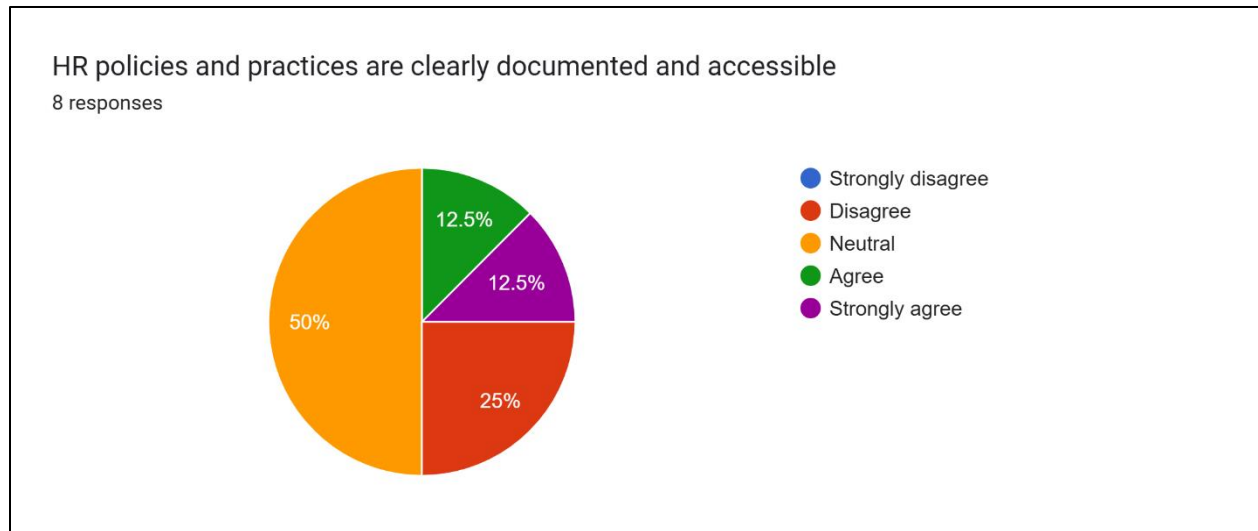
At ZLK Securities, HR appears to support core business activities like trading, research and client services through relevant training and by enabling branches with qualified staff. A strong emphasis on investor education and professional support implies HR fosters client-oriented competencies and knowledge sharing.

Chapter 4

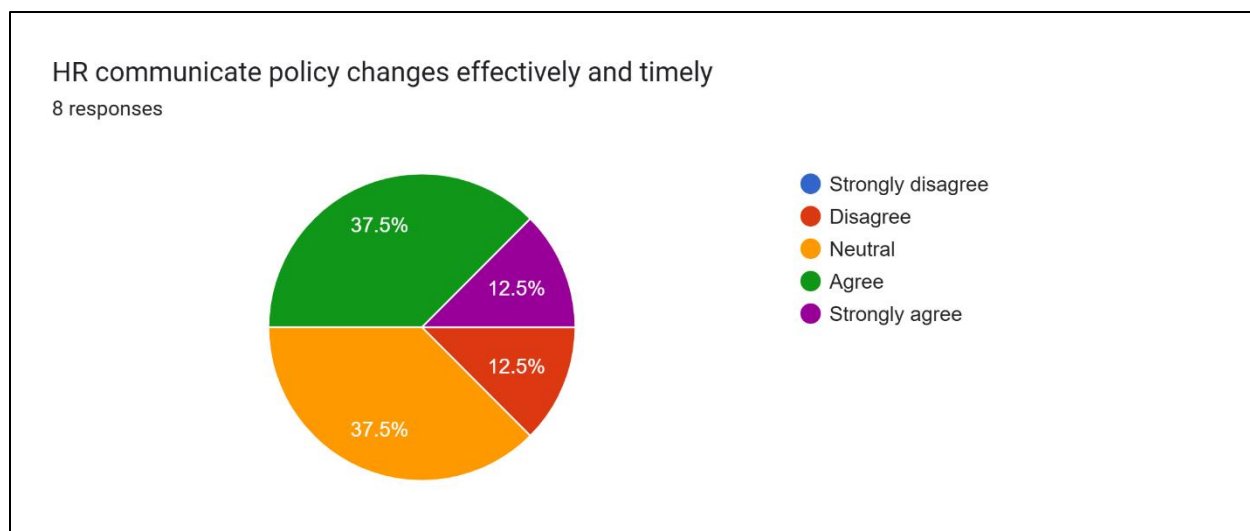
Survey findings

Qualitative approach of data collection was used in this study. Survey and interviews were conducted with the employees of Zahid Latif Khan Securities pvt Ltd to know about their experience with the implemented HR policies and to find out the gaps and the challenges they faced.

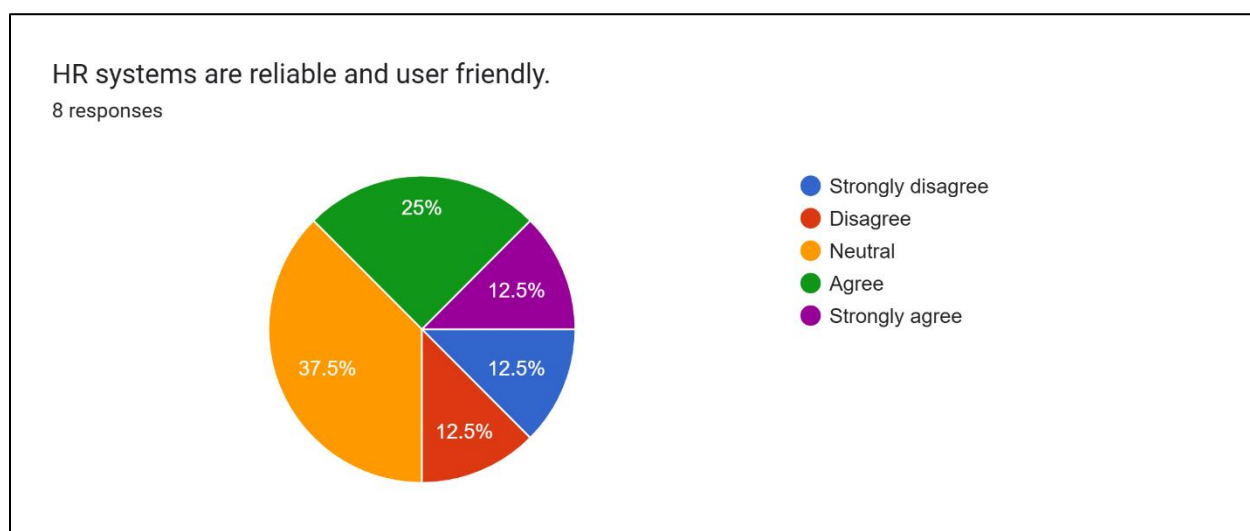
4.1 Review of Existing PMS & HR policies



When the employees are asked do you think in your organization, the HR personals communicate policies timely and whether these policies are clearly documented and accessible to all employees or not. Mixed responses were gathered, **25%** agree that HR policies and practices are clearly documented and accessible to all employees. A noticeable number of employees (**25%**) simply disagreed, which is the indication that employees find it difficult to access or understand HR policies.



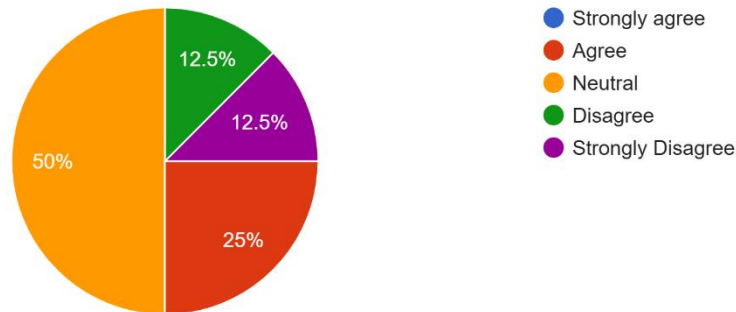
The employees were asked whether the HR communicate policy changes effectively and timely. Based on the results gathered from the survey, **38%** of workforce agree that HR communicate policy changes effectively and timely, and **38%** of the employees gave mixed response suggesting that many employees are unsure. **12.5%** of the employees are those who disagree, indicating some dissatisfaction, whereas a small group of employees have a positive review regarding this matter.



Employees were asked whether the HR system at ZLK is reliable and user-friendly. The responses suggest a somewhat uncertain view of HR systems at ZLK Brokerage House. An unsafety about the reliability and user-friendliness of the systems was observed in the largest group of employees whose response (**37.5%**) remains neutral. While **25%** agree that the systems are reliable and easy to use, a combined **25%** (12.5% disagree and 12.5% strongly disagree) express dissatisfaction. Additionally, **12.5%** strongly agree, showing that a small group has a very positive experience.

The PMS is used consistently across all the departments.

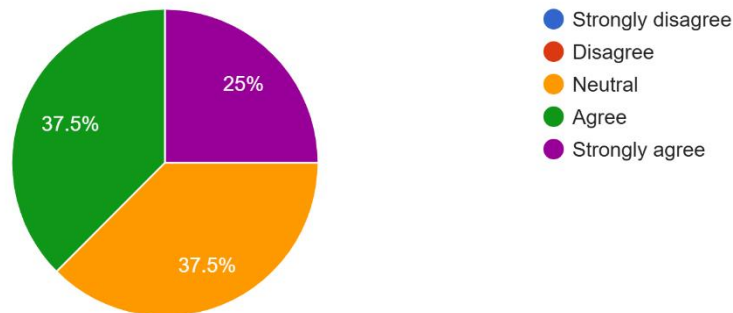
8 responses



The survey findings show that Performance Management System is not used very regularly across departments at Zahid Latif Khan Securities. **4 out of 8** responses show a neutral response, meaning many employees are in doubt on the use of PMS across departments. While a significant number of employees think that PMS is used consistently.

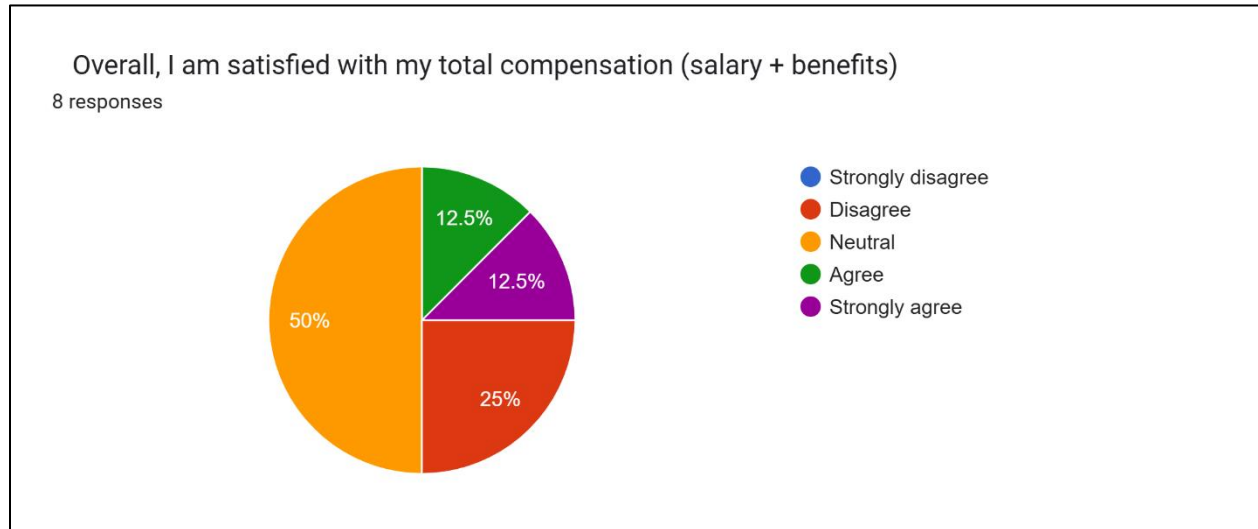
Performance goals are linked to company objectives

8 responses

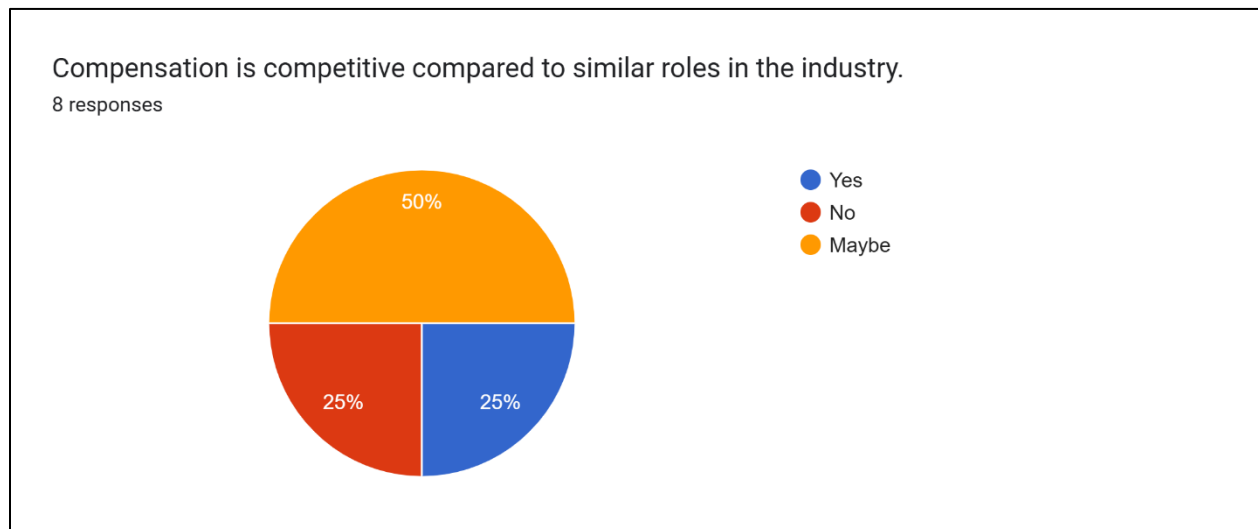


The results of this survey show a generally positive view that performance goals are linked to company objectives. Around **60%** of the employees who are working in the ZLK Securities strongly agree that there is clear connection between the performance goals and the company's direction. But on other side there is a significant number of employees who are unsure how performance goals are linked to ZLK Securities objectives.

4.2 Compensation and Benefit Structure



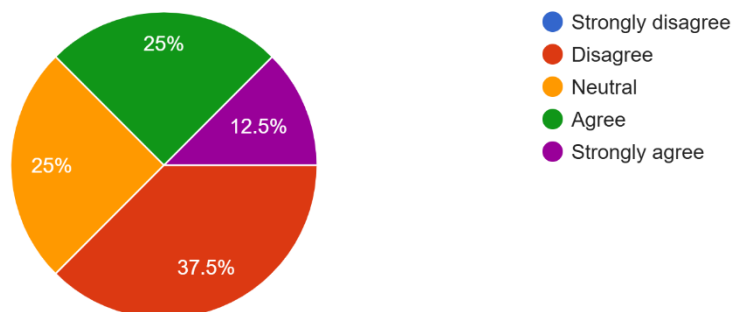
When employees were asked whether they are satisfied with their current salary package, **4 out of 8** employees gave mixed indicating that many 50% of the employees think that their salaries are low compared to the others who are working on the same position in different organization. Meanwhile, **25%** disagreed, reflecting some level of dissatisfaction. On the positive side, only a small proportion of employees, less than **30%**, agree to their total compensation including monetary and non-monetary benefits. In order to improve employee satisfaction and to ensure that employees remain loyal to organization, the organization should make certain improvements in total compensation package.



Based on the survey, the perception of whether compensation is competitive compared to similar roles in the industry is quite uncertain. Half of the respondents (50%) selected “Maybe,” indicating that many employees are unsure about how their pay compares to the market. Meanwhile, 25% believe that compensation is competitive, while another 25% feel it is not.

Non-monetary benefits (flexible hours, remote work, recognition) are adequate.

8 responses

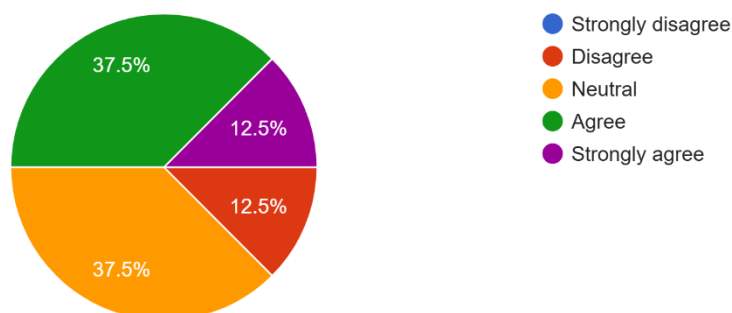


Based on the survey, employees have mixed opinions about the adequacy of non-monetary benefits at ZLK Brokerage House. A larger portion (**37.5%**) disagrees, indicating that many employees feel these benefits are not sufficient. Meanwhile, **25%** agree and **12.5%** strongly agree, showing that some employees are satisfied. Another **25%** remain neutral, suggesting uncertainty or average perception.

4.3 Training and Development

Section D: Training & Development The organization regularly assesses training needs for employees.

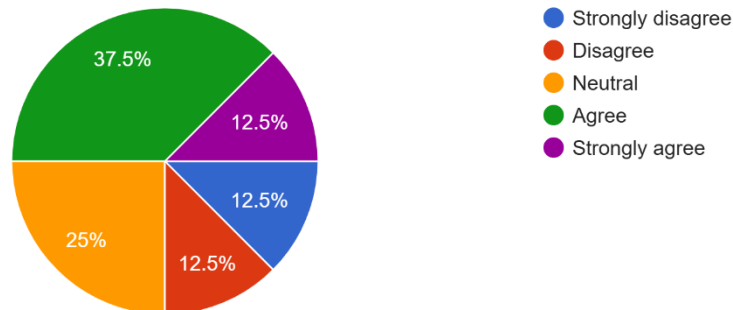
8 responses



Most of the respondents who participated in the research have mixed view regarding whether the organization regularly assesses training needs. About **38%** of the respondents feel that training needs are enough to meet company objectives. However, an equal **37.5%** remain neutral, suggesting uncertainty or inconsistency in this process. Small proportion of the respondents show some dissatisfaction, and **12.5%** strongly agree, reflecting a small group with a very positive experience.

I have access to the learning resources I need (courses, coaching, e-learning).

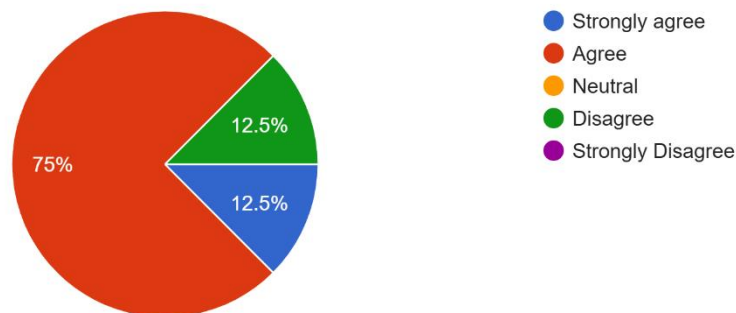
8 responses



Based on the survey, employees have a somewhat positive but mixed view about access to learning resources at ZLK Brokerage House. The large group of respondents agree that they have access to the resources they need, while some of the employees strongly agree that they have access to e-courses, coaching and training modules. Survey finding reveals that there is a strong connection. While there are few participants who provided neutral responses, **25%** of the employees feel that they do not have access to adequate training resources.

Training opportunities are relevant to my job and career aspirations.

8 responses

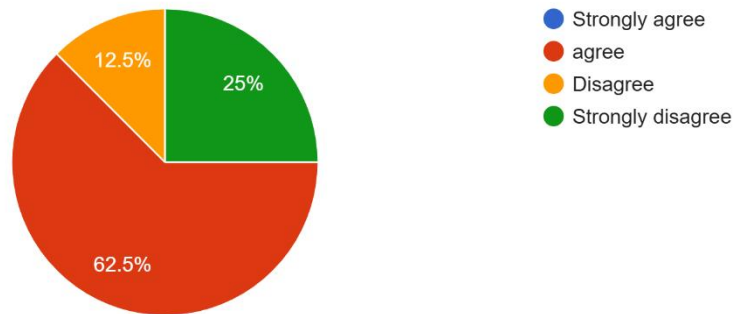


Employees have a strongly positive view about the relevance of training opportunities to their job and career goals, and the survey findings are the clear indication of this. Around **87%** agree, showing that most employees find the training useful and aligned with their needs. However, a small group of employees feels the training is not relevant to their roles.

4.4 Issues and Challenges

Onboarding effectively prepares new hires to perform.

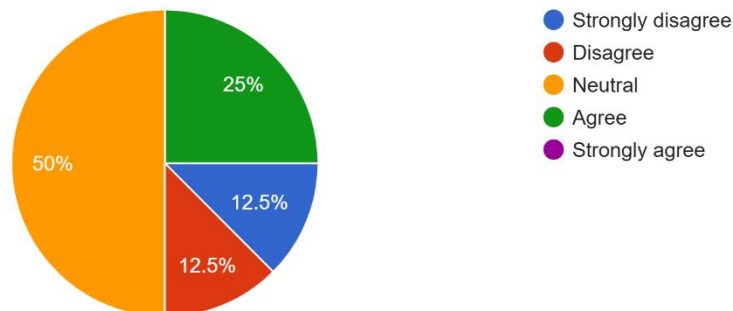
8 responses



Based on the survey, most employees feel that onboarding effectively prepares new hires to perform, with a majority of **62.5%** agreeing. However, **12.5%** disagree and **25%** strongly disagree, indicating that a significant portion of employees believe onboarding is not fully effective. There is still room for improvement as no respondent strongly agreed.

Promotions and internal mobility are based on merit and transparency.

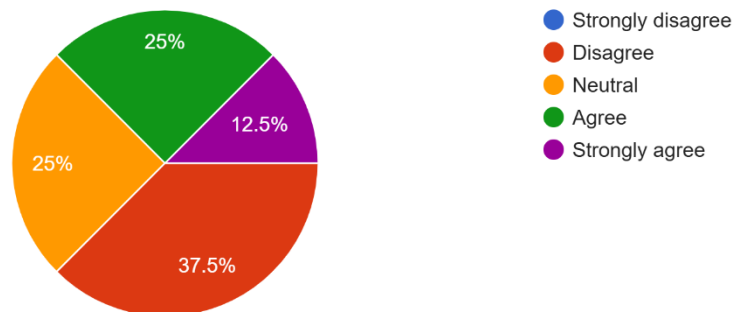
8 responses



Based on the survey findings, employees are not sure what to exactly say they have a mixed opinion regarding promotions and internal mobility whether they are based on merit or totally based on favoritism. Around **4 out of 8** employees (50%) gave a neutral response, indicating that many are unsure or do not clearly see fairness in the process. While rest agree that promotions are merit-based and transparent, a combined **25%** (12.5% disagree and 12.5% strongly disagree) feel otherwise.

HR has sufficient staff and expertise to support business needs.

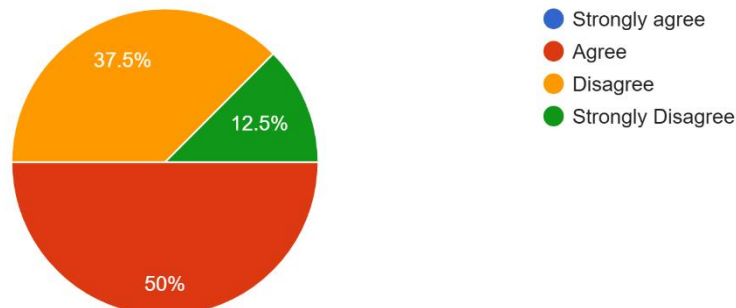
8 responses



A larger portion (37.5%) disagrees, indicating concerns about HR capacity and capability. Meanwhile, 25% agree and 12.5% strongly agree, showing that some employees feel HR support is adequate. Another 25% remain neutral, suggesting uncertainty.

There is low bureaucracy when addressing HR issues.

8 responses

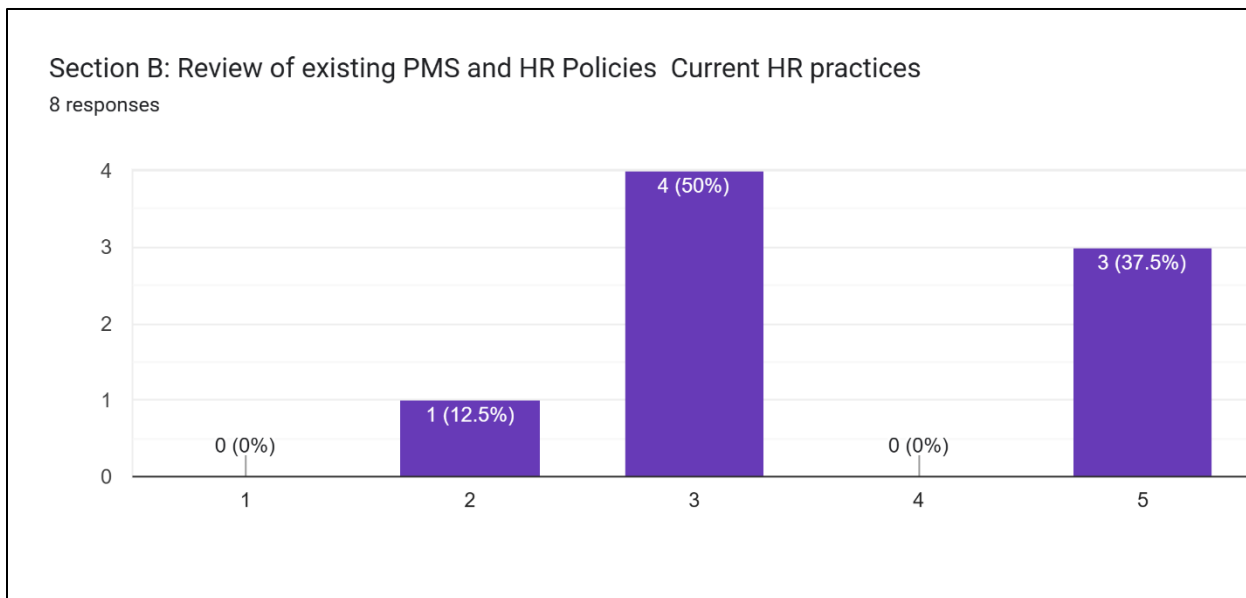


Based on the survey findings, around 50% of the respondents who are currently working there in the brokerage agree with the fact that they feel that there is low bureaucracy in ZLK Securities when dealing with HR issues. However, 50% (37% disagree and 13% strongly disagree) of the employees think that there is high bureaucracy which slows down the hiring practices, delays or complicated processes. As no employee strongly agreed, which suggests that the process is not seen as very smooth.

Overall Review of existing PMS and HR Policies

Based on the survey, the review of existing PMS and HR policies at ZLK Brokerage House shows a moderately positive perception, with an average rating of **3.63 out of 5**. HR practices at

ZLK are rated as average by **50%** of the respondents, who are mainly the employees working there in ZLK Securities. It is a clear indication that HR practices are functional but not highly effective. But **37.5%** of the individuals are those who expressed high level of satisfaction. A small portion, around **12.5%** of the employees rated HR practices below average, thus showing



minimal dissatisfaction.

A significant portion of survey responses falls under the “**neutral**” category, which should not be perceived as satisfaction. But it should be interpreted as uncertainty, lack of awareness, or hesitation among employees to express negative opinions.

When employees were asked if you were the HR manager what HR policies would you change immediately. Employees highlighted the three main areas on which they would be focusing more

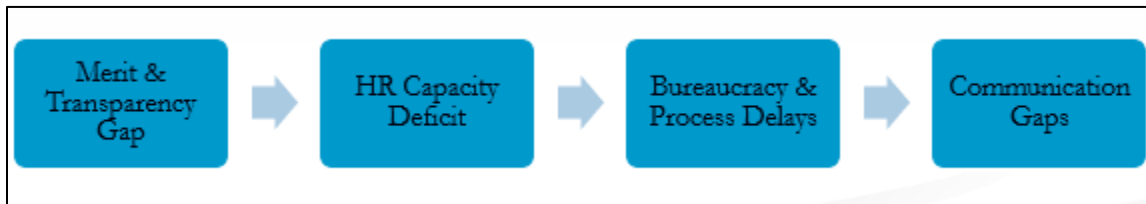
- On employee’s well-being
- Growth opportunities
- Implement regular mental health check-ins and flexible work arrangements.

A lot of companies in Pakistan including Careem who are working with the right approach to prioritize employee wellness. One employee thinks that many people are rejected because of their resumes that seem unprofessional. Rather than this every candidate should be given equal chances of interview to showcase their abilities. Few respondents think that HR policies are shared and explained. Right now, they are not very clear or easy to access, which can be confusing. If everything is properly documented and easy to understand, it would make things smoother for employees.

Chapter 5

Gap Analysis

Based on the survey and interview findings, a detailed gap analysis of Zahid Latif Khan Brokerage House reveals several misalignments between its HR strategy and actual practices, which can be further understood when linked with established HRM literature and best practices in financial services firms such as brokerage houses.



5.1 PMS Implementation gap

Firstly, there is a clear **gap in the implementation of the Performance Management System (PMS)**. Although PMS is expected to align individual performance with organizational goals (Armstrong, 2020), the survey shows that 50% of employees are neutral about its consistent use across departments. Employees' performance, accountability and the outcomes are the three major aspects that define brokerage house. In order to identify talent, understand competencies and to address performance gaps by the management PMS needs to be implemented. This positive approach not only improves operational efficiency but also position corporations to navigate market changes smoothly (Eletive, 2024).

5.2 Communication gap

Transparency and communication gaps are evident from survey findings. It was Dassler who thinks that transparent policies and open communication build trust and improve employee engagement. More than 50% of the employees give neutral responses to the question whether HR policies are clearly documented or whether promotions are merit-based or not. In brokerage firms, where ethical practices and trust are essential, lack of clarity in policies and promotions can lead to dissatisfaction and reduced organizational commitment. There are certain motivational theories such as Vroom's Expectancy Theory and Adams' Equity Theory which suggest that fair, competitive, and performance-based compensation is essential for motivating workforce and retaining talent (GeeksforGeeks, 2025).

5.3 HR capacity and capability

Another important issue is **HR capacity and capability**. In order to achieve strategic differentiation, Ulrich defines human capability as a collective set of leadership, expertise and culture (O'Donoghue, 2021). From survey findings it's clearer that 40% of the workforce feel

that ZLK Securities lacks sufficient staff and expertise. This suggests that Human Resource department at Zahid Latif Khan Securities instead of functioning strategically is more operational, limiting its ability to support business growth and talent management effectively.

5.4 Talent Management gap

Retention and hiring of skilled employees should be top priority that brokerage firms should focus on as it provides structured onboarding, and continuous development due to the competitive nature of the industry. While the survey shows that onboarding is effective for some (62.5% agree), a notable percentage disagrees, indicating inconsistency. Additionally, mixed responses regarding access to learning resources suggest that talent development is not equally prioritized, which contradicts the literature emphasizing continuous skill development in financial services.

5.5. Reward and compensation system

The **reward and compensation system** also reflects a significant gap. There are certain motivational theories such as Expectancy Theory (Vroom, 1964) and Adams' Equity Theory (Adams, 1965) which suggest that fair, competitive, and performance-based compensation is essential for motivating workforce and retaining talent.

Survey findings reveal that 50% of employees are not even sure about their compensation packages and remaining half of the percentage of employees are dissatisfied with their salary package. Remaining 50% of the workforce are unsure if compensation is competitive in the market. Reduction in motivation and increase turnover risk occurs due to unclear or uncompetitive rewards in a brokerage house, where performance-based incentives are crucial.

After analyzing the survey results, it was found that **non-monetary benefits and employee engagement practices** at **ZLK Securities** appear weak. In the view of employees there is a need of improving overall compensation and benefits, especially salaries and incentives.

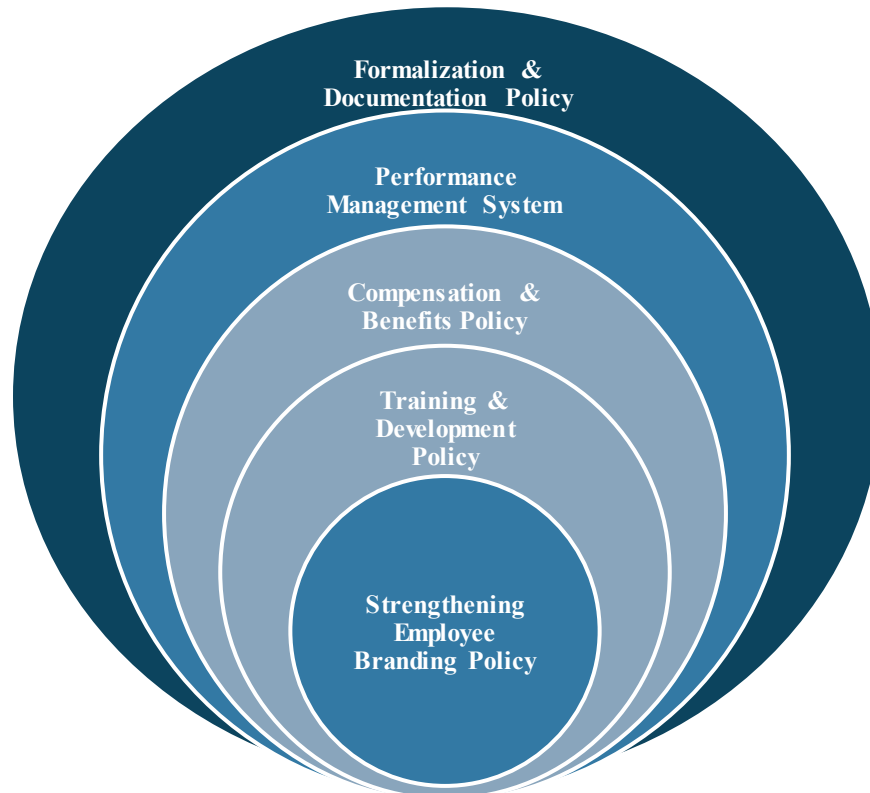
Compensation and benefit must be competitive in order to support and motivate employees and if the remuneration levels are not competitive employees may leave the organization. There is strong evidence from the literature which suggests that in order to enhance employee satisfaction, recognition and career growth opportunities must be tied with employee performance (Fomin, 2026). Employees think that overall compensation and benefits need improvement, especially salaries and incentives. Monetary benefits should be more competitive and fairer to better support and motivate employees.

5.6. Training and development gap

From a **training and development perspective**, 75% of the respondents agree that training is relevant. On other hand remaining 35% of the respondents find lack of consistency in training need assessments. In brokerage house environment training should be continuous, data-driven, and aligned with both regulatory requirements and market changes. Employees feel that current

training opportunities are enough to perform well but few trainings on digital technology and marketing skills must be there to meet company strategic goals.

Proposed HR policy for ZLK



1. Policy on Formalization and Documentation

Ensure all HR policies are clearly defined, documented, and accessible.

Key Actions:

- Comprehensive HR Policy Manual development for ZLK which covers PMS, compensation, promotions, leave, and code of conduct
- For easy employee access, creation of a centralized digital HR portal for all HR related activities
- In order to keep employees, traders and brokers up to date on ongoing organizational policies, quarterly or monthly sessions should be arranged.

Rationale: In survey responses lack of awareness and accessibility was visible in employees, which showed high neutrality regarding policy clarity

2. Performance Management System (PMS) Policy

Strengthen and standardize PMS across all departments.

Key Actions:

- A **uniform PMS framework** will be implemented with KPIs aligned to company objectives
- Continuous feedback is given to employees through introduction of **bi-annual performance reviews**
- Through creation of transparent merit-based frameworks, PMS outcomes can be linked with **rewards, promotions, and training plans**.

Rationale

A reduction in employee trust can occur due to lack of consistency across departments while implementing Performance Management System (PMS), which can lead to unequal evaluation and is also depicted in one of the findings. This issue likely arises from the absence of standardized KPIs and insufficient managerial training in performance evaluation. It's important to ensure uniformity in appraisal systems, especially in the industries where performance-related rewards are given to employees to maintain fairness and accountability.

3. Career Development and Succession Planning Policy

Provide clear career growth pathways for employees.

Key Actions:

- In order to help the candidates for future leadership roles, **Individual Development Plans (IDPs)** should be designed for all employees working there in ZLK Securities
- Employees can easily align their personal ambitions with ZLK objectives by introduction of career progression framework. Managers can easily get to know about what skills employees lack.
- Offer **training and mentorship programs**.

4. Compensation and Benefits Policy

Compensation structure should be fair, competitive, and according to the market structure. Compensation should be designed to motivate the employees to work for a longer time in the same firm.

Key Actions:

- ZLK Securities can conduct **market benchmarking analysis to benchmark the pay of its employees** to ensure competitive salaries.

- Introducing **performance-based incentives, merit-pay, and profit-sharing opportunities** to motivate the employees
- Improve **non-monetary benefits** such as:
 - Flexible working hours (Hybrid)
 - Appreciation letters
 - Feedback
 - Paid leaves
 - Recognition programs
 - Fuel and travel allowances

5. Training and Development Policy

Ensure continuous employee learning and skill development.

Key Actions:

- Conduct **regular training needs assessments**.
- Utilize diverse training methodologies including **courses, e-learning, and coaching** to cater to different learning styles and preferences.
- Peer to peer learning sessions
- Aligning training with business goals and employee career aspirations

Rationale: While training relevance is high, employees highlight that there is a need of improvement. However, major proportion of the workforce thinks that trainings are sufficient but in interview respondents highlighted the importance of **technical and digital skill development**, including software courses, emerging technologies, on job training and advanced digital/media marketing skills. Variety in the training keeps employees engaged and encouraged to learn. Employees highlighted that there is a need of training to improve Communication skills. Survey findings reveals that there is a need for greater access to professional courses and certifications to provide employees with knowledge and skills to compete in a competitive world.

6. Strengthening Employer Branding through HR Practices

Improved HR practices can contribute significantly to building a strong employer brand for ZLK Securities. In a competitive financial market, attracting and retaining skilled professionals requires more than just competitive salaries. In today's job market, positive reputation is essential for competitiveness. ZLK can position itself as a desirable workplace, thereby gaining **access to high-quality talent**. This is only possible when the branding and communication are strong.

Implementation & Control

The implementation of the proposed HR policies at ZLK Brokerage House should follow a structured and strategic approach to ensure effectiveness. Armstrong (2020) in one of his articles mentioned that successful HR implementation requires clear planning, communication, and consistent execution. Zahid Latif Khan Securities (Pvt) Ltd should begin by formalizing all HR policies into a documented manual. Implementation of **AI-powered ATS and 9-box Grid Software** will enable the HR personnels to focus more on organization objectives. Clear documentation is important and this is particularly important as survey findings showed high neutrality regarding policy awareness and clarity.

Policy communication through workshops, emails and awareness sessions should be conducted in a phased manner to enhance the effectiveness of communication. The mixed views on survey responses seconded Dessler (2020) thoughts which emphasize that effective communication is critical for policy understanding. For consistent application of policies, training sessions for managers and HR staff should be conducted especially for PMS, where survey results indicated inconsistency across departments.

Inefficiencies, concerns related to bureaucracy, training effectiveness, compensation tracking and employee records can be tracked timely in an efficient way with the introduction of Human Resource Information System. Before implementing HRIS at ZLK Securities a pilot phase will be conducted, to gather feedback from pilot groups and to identify the early operational challenges. In case any operational challenges occur in pilot testing phase, the challenges will be resolved at spot. Implementation of HRIS software's at ZLK is beneficial as HR team is overloaded with onboarding and setting up employee's benefits, but with implementation of this HRIS systems, these onboarding tasks can become automated.

Control and Monitoring

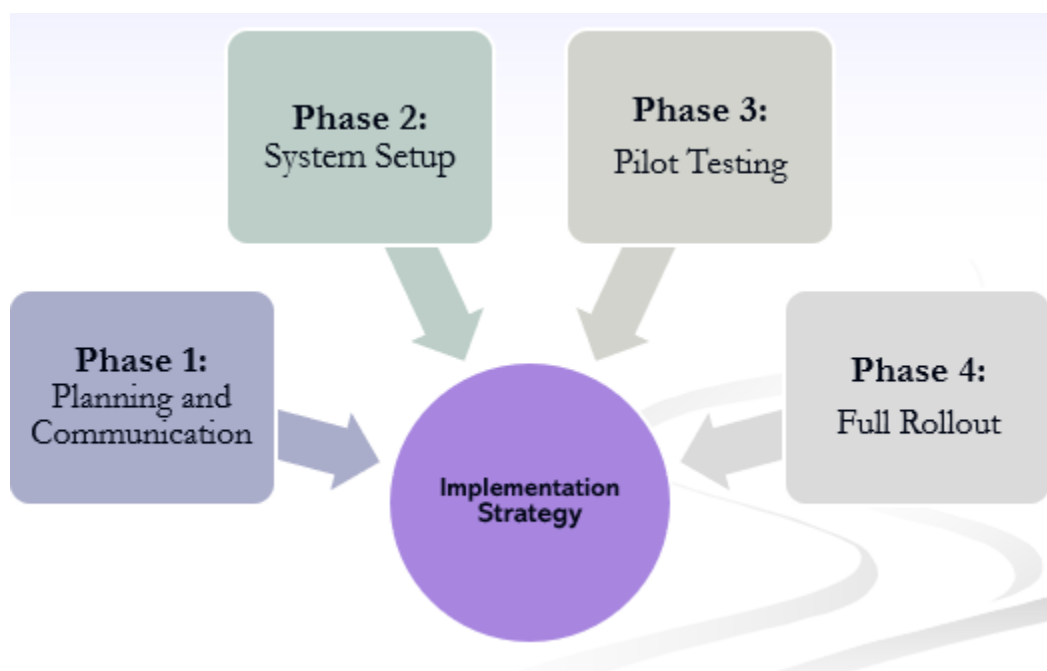
One must take control to implement sustainability, strong control mechanisms at ZLK. It was Becker and Huselid who suggested that HR effectiveness should be measured through performance outcomes. Therefore, ZLK should define Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) such as employee satisfaction, retention rates, PMS completion, and training participation.

Employee surveys, feedback sessions, and performance audits should be conducted to monitor the workforce. Access to e-learning resources and HR support is crucial as survey findings revealed mixed perceptions in areas like compensation, training access, and HR support. When employees were asked if you guys were the HR manager what HR practices would you change immediately. Workforce responded that they would be focusing on improving employee well-being and growth opportunities. Specifically, implementing regular mental health check-ins and flexible work arrangements. As there are many companies in Pakistan, like Careem which prioritize employee wellness, showing it's possible with the right approach. **Real-time performance analytics** and **360-Degree feedback system** should also be implemented in ZLK

Securities, thus allowing employees to report concerns, improving transparency and providing immediate feedbacks to employees' concern.

Performance review should be conducted periodically by senior management to evaluate HR performance, ensuring alignment with organizational strategy. In order to ensure effective HR practices Harvard Model of HRM highlights the importance of continuous evaluation and stakeholder involvement. Continuous evaluation act as feedback loop that treat HR outcomes as a source of data to improve future strategies instead of treating these outcomes as an end point. Managers can utilize HRM model to monitor long term impact of these policies on workforce and on the organization. Here 4Cs approach comes into play, as it acts as qualitative metric to determine the impact of proposed policies on the organization.

The effectiveness of HR policies largely depends on the role of line managers, as line manager plays a pivotal role in selecting the perfect candidates who fit with teams' culture and organizational value. If a line manager is unable to communicate these policies effectively or he is unable to implement them properly then in this case well-designed policies can fail. From survey findings it's found that in the implementation of HR policies at **ZLK Securities** the involvement of top management or line manager is limited. HR professionals at ZLK Securities need to collaborate closely with the senior management of brokerage house to identify the HR priorities and develop clear strategies that support organization goal. Therefore, it is essential to train and empower HR professionals to take ownership of HR practices, ensuring better execution and stronger employee engagement to set a solid foundation for success integration.



Risk and mitigation strategies

1. Inconsistent Implementation Across Departments

As indicated by survey findings, one risk is that policies like PMS may not be applied uniformly in ZLK securities and brokerage house.

These risks can be mitigated by

- Following standardized protocols
- Assign clear responsibilities
- Conducting regular audits

2. Lack of HR Capacity and Expertise

Survey findings reveal that HR lack expertise and skills.

These issues which can occur due to lack of HR Personnel and skilled can be mitigated by

- Invest in training HR professionals
- Hire skilled professionals
- Make use of Human Resource Information System to improve efficiency

ZLK Securities must adopt a structured approach that includes clear communication, training sessions, and gradual implementation.

3. Poor Communication and Low Awareness

From survey findings it's clear that all employees are not fully aware of policies, leading to confusion and dissatisfaction.

The issue of poor communication and low awareness can be mitigated using different strategies

- By using multiple communication channels
- Accessible documentation
- Regular updating the employees about the implemented policies and procedures

4. Compensation Dissatisfaction and Turnover Risk

Neutral and negative responses regarding compensation may lead to low motivation and attrition.

The risk associated with compensation dissatisfaction and employee turnover can be met by

- Conducting market benchmark analysis
- Introducing performance-based incentives such as insurance and partnerships
- Promote a risk-aware culture within ZLK Securities, encouraging the workforce to identify and report risk.

5. Bureaucracy and Process Delays

Based on the results of the survey workforce reported inefficiencies in HR processes.

This risk can be mitigated by

- Digitalizing the HR processes
- Set response timelines
- Simplifying the protocols by eradicating the unnecessary steps

ZLK Securities must adopt a structured approach that includes clear communication, training sessions, and gradual implementation.

Conclusion

In conclusion, better HR practices can play a major role in building a strong employer brand for ZLK Securities. In a competitive financial market, it takes more than just good salaries to attract and keep skilled professionals. Due to lack of uncertainties and low understanding ability employees and managers may resist change. So, in my suggestion Zahid Latif Khan Ltd needs a clear implementation plan that includes open communication channel where employees and employer can discuss issues which they face. This, in turn, will improve the effectiveness of HR initiatives. Moreover, this brokerage and financial service provider can greatly improve decision-making by using HR Analytics. Furthermore, the brokerage house can monitor critical metrics like employee turnover, training effectiveness, absenteeism patterns and performance trends. This data-driven approach helps HR to identify the gaps on early basis and implement focused solutions. An organization reputation is greatly improved as employer of choice by creating a positive work culture showcasing clear career paths, and effective training opportunities for betterment of employees. ZLK can become a more attractive workplace and gain access to high-quality talent by strengthening its HR systems.

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